

Afifah Kashif

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Research interests: AI evaluation [1,3–5,7,11], human-AI and human-robot interaction [2,6,8,10], AI governance [3,8–10]

EDUCATION

University of Cambridge

Cambridge, UK

M.Phil. Human-Inspired Artificial Intelligence (with Distinction)

Oct 2025 – Jun 2026

Dissertation: Bias by Whose Definition? The Construct Validity of Dictionary-Based and LLM-as-Judge Bias

Evaluation in Conversational AI (Supervisors: Dr. Jin Huang, Dr. Malak Sadek, Dr. Hatice Gunes)

University of Washington, Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering

Seattle, USA

B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Law, Societies & Justice

Sep 2022 – Jun 2025

Study Abroad: Rome, Italy (Jan – Mar 2024), Honors: *The Global Refugee Crisis: From Devastation to Diaspora*

GPA: 3.77/4.00, Dean's List, Completed one year early

Capstone: Ointment Care Robot for Limited Mobility Users (Instructor: Dr. Maya Cakmak)

Bellevue College

Bellevue, USA

A.A. Arts and Sciences; A.S. Engineering, Physics and Atmospheric Sciences

Sep 2020 – Jun 2022

Earned concurrently with high school through dual credit; GPA: 3.98/4.00, Dean's List

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Visiting Researcher, Stanford University

Sep 2026 – Present

Prof. Julian Nyarko, Dr. Megan Ma (Legal Innovation through Frontier Technology Lab, Stanford Law School)

Research Assistant, University of Cambridge

Jul 2026 – Present

Dr. Katie Seaborn (Aspire Lab, Department of Computer Science and Technology), Dr. Malak Sadek (HIVE Lab,

Centre for Human Inspired AI)

Researcher, PluralisticAI Lab

Mar 2026 – Present

Dr. Zhenzhen Qi (University of Connecticut), Dr. Avijit Ghosh (Hugging Face)

CORDA Democracy Fellow, Odyssean Institute

Apr 2026 – Sep 2026

Jacob Haimes (Apart Research), Dr. Swaptik Chowdhury (RAND)

Research Assistant, University of Washington

Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

Dr. Amy Ko (Wordplay Project, UW Information School)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Robotics Software Engineering Intern, Hello Robot

May 2025 – Aug 2025

Human-Robot Interaction and UX focus (Dr. Vinitha Ranganeni)

Backend Software Engineering Intern, HowellCo

Jul 2024 – Sep 2024

Software Engineering Intern, Code.org

Jul 2023 – Sep 2023

Operations and Product Intern, Fiveable

Apr 2021 – Nov 2021

PUBLICATIONS

[1] Refusal Is Not Scored: A Coverage Limit in Content-Based Bias Evaluation

Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek, Jin Huang, Hatice Gunes

JUDGE Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026 [Under Review]

[2] Designing Power Systems as a Social Interface for Assistive Robots

Afifah Kashif, Vy Nguyen, Vinitha Ranganeni

ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2027. [Under Review]

[3] Synthetic Dataset Creation as Governance Infrastructure for Embodied AI Bias Evaluation

Afifah Kashif

UK AI Research Symposium (UKAIRS) 2026, Emerging Research Track. [Peer-Reviewed, Accepted]

[4] Do Language and Visual Perturbations Compound? Interaction Effects and Backend Sensitivity in Compact Vision-Language-Action Model Evaluation

Abdul Muhsin Hameed, Afifah Kashif, Asim Iqbal

International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2027. [Under Review]

[5] Vision-Language-Action Models Need Neuroscience's Evaluation Toolkit, Not Just Its Architectures

Abdul Muhsin Hameed, Afifah Kashif, Asim Iqbal

Workshop on Grounded and Faithful Vision-Language Models for Real-World Deployment (VLM4RWD) @ NeurIPS 2026. [Under Review]

[6] Beyond the Monolithic Interface: A Research Agenda for Plural Conversational AI

Avijit Ghosh, Afifah Kashif, Isabelle Kohout, Zhenzhen Qi

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (Nature Portfolio). [Under Review]

[7] Mapping Collective Imaginaries of AI Risk: Expert Elicitation, Causal Modeling and LLM-Assisted Coding

Anshikha Kumar, Afifah Kashif, Jacob Haimes, Swaptik Chowdhury

AI4GOOD Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026. [Under Review]

[8] Governance as Methodology: Toward Anticipatory, Design-Embedded Governance for Human-Robot Interaction

Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek

2nd Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2026. [Peer-Reviewed; Presented]

[9] Governance at the Edge of Architecture: Regulating NeuroAI and Neuromorphic Systems

Afifah Kashif, Abdul Hameed, Asim Iqbal

arXiv:2602.01503, 2026. [Preprint]

[10] Regulatory Considerations for Physically Assistive Robotics Researchers

Afifah Kashif, Amal Nanavati, Maya Cakmak

Physical Caregiving Robots Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2025. [Peer-reviewed; Presented]

[11] Assessing GPT's Bias Towards Stigmatized Social Groups: An Intersectional Case Study on Nationality Prejudice and Psychophobia

Afifah Kashif*, Heer Patel*

*Equal contribution

Considering Cultural and Linguistic Diversity in AI Applications Workshop @ ASIS&T 2024. [Peer-reviewed; Presented]

Other Writing

The Hidden Social Costs of AI

EvalEval Coalition. Blog Post. November 2025.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Winner, Hack the Law Research Pitch (2026): Stanford x Cambridge competition for funded research placement.

Top 5 Nominee, Academic Representative of the Year (2026): Cambridge Excellence Awards.

Marcy Migdal Fellowship (2025): UW Center for Global Studies; funded a digital literacy program for recently resettled refugee women.

Nordic Scholars Leadership Institute (2025): Inaugural cohort, Stockholm, Sweden.

Distinguished Leader Award (2023): Harvard WECODE.

TALKS

Panelist, "Intergenerational Perspectives on AI in a Changing World"	Jun 2026
<i>Centre for Human-Inspired AI, Annual Conference, University of Cambridge Union</i>	

Dissertation Seminar, "Bias by Whose Definition?"	May 2026
<i>Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge</i>	

Speaker, CHIA Early Career Community Event	May 2026
<i>Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge</i>	

Guest Lecture, "An Ethical AI Lens for Neuroinclusive Design"	Feb 2026
<i>Inclusive Design Futures (Dr. Matteo Zallio), University of Cambridge</i>	

Speaker, “The Politics of Educational Technology”
Clareity × Whiston Series, Clare College 700th Anniversary, University of Cambridge

Feb 2026

TEACHING

Supervisor, Computer Science and Human-Computer Interaction <i>University of Cambridge</i>	Oct 2025 – Mar 2026 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Founder and Instructor, Digital Literacy Program <i>International Rescue Committee and Kabul Seattle Community Services</i>	Jan 2025 – Present <i>Seattle, WA</i>
Teaching Assistant, Intro Programming and The Hardware/Software Interface <i>University of Washington</i>	Jan 2023 – Mar 2025 <i>Seattle, WA</i>
Section Leader, Code in Place <i>Stanford University</i>	Apr 2024 – May 2024 <i>Remote</i>
Language and Literacy Teacher <i>CPIAI Roma</i>	Jan 2024 – Mar 2024 <i>Rome, Italy</i>

SERVICE

Program Committee: UserSim: Grounded User Simulation Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026	
Workshop Host: CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Conference 2024 (first and only undergraduate team)	
Event Organizer: Shared Futures Foundation Buildathon, London, 2026, Techtogether Hackathon, Seattle, 2026	
Member: EvalEval Coalition	2025 – Present
AI Research Events Lead: Cambridge AI Research Society	2026 – Present
Academic Representative: Cambridge Institute of Technology and Humanity	2025 – Present
Executive Officer: Paul G. Allen School Student Advisory Council, University of Washington	2022 – 2024
Co-Founder and Vice President: Women in Law Society, University of Washington	2023 – 2025

LANGUAGES

English (native), Urdu/Hindi (native)